# Conditional type 1

**Goal:** To express a real possibility in the future and its consequence with the first conditional (*If + present simple, will + base verb*), for example when talking about dreams, studies and ambitions.

**The idea in two lines:** Conditional type 1 describes something that can really happen. The *if*-clause gives the condition in the present simple; the main clause gives the result with *will* (or *can*, *may*, an imperative).

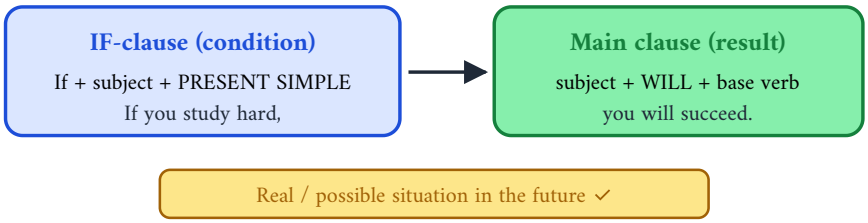



Figure 1: Structure of the first conditional: present simple in the condition, will + base verb in the result.

## 🔵 Rules and concepts

1. **Structure:** *If + present simple, will + base verb.* Example: *If it rains, we will stay at home.*
2. **Use:** a real or likely condition in the present or future and its probable result. It is used for advice, warnings, promises and plans.
3. **Order of clauses:** the *if*-clause can come first (with a comma) or second (no comma): *We will stay at home if it rains.*
4. **Other results:** instead of *will*, the main clause may use *can*, *may*, *might*, *should* or an imperative: *If you finish early, you can go out. / If you see Karim, tell him to call me.*
5. **Unless** = *if ... not*: *Unless you hurry, you will miss the bus* = *If you don't hurry, ...*

6. **Negative forms:** *If he doesn't train, he won't win.* Third person singular takes *-s* or *doesn't* in the *if*-clause.
7. The condition is in the present tense even though it refers to the future: never put *will* after *if*.

### 🟢 Examples

1. Complete: *If Samir ..... (get) good marks, his parents ..... (buy) him a bike.*
   **Solution:** If Samir **gets** good marks, his parents **will buy** him a bike.
   **Explanation:** present simple with *-s* for *Samir*; *will* + base verb in the result.
2. Rewrite with *unless*: *If you don't practise, you won't improve your English.*
   **Solution: Unless** you practise, you won't improve your English.
3. Reorder: *she / if / a scholarship / she / will / abroad / gets / study*. **Solution:** If she gets a scholarship, she will study abroad. / She will study abroad if she gets a scholarship.

### 🟠 Common BEM mistakes

- *If it will rain* × → *If it rains* ✓ (no *will* in the *if*-clause).
- Forgetting the *-s*: *If he study* × → *If he studies* ✓.
- Using *unless ... not* together: *Unless you don't work* ×.
- Mixing types: present simple in the condition but *would* in the result (that is type 2).

### 🟡 Quick review

- Type 1 = real possibility: If + present simple, will + base verb.
- Comma only when the *if*-clause comes first.
- Result can also use can / may / might / imperative.
- unless = if ... not.
- Never *if + will*.